

AFP

French AI startup AMI announces \$1 bn raised in funding

AFP

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AI pioneer Yann LeCun spent 12 years at Meta (Yui Mok) · Yui Mok/POOL/AFP

French artificial intelligence startup AMI, co-founded by Meta's former chief AI scientist Yann LeCun, announced Tuesday it has raised \$1 billion to develop models able to understand the physical world.

This first funding round for AMI (Advanced Machine Intelligence) was carried out by five investment funds and attracted investment from several big groups, including Toyota, Nvidia and Samsung.

Notable names in tech, including former Google CEO Eric Schmidt and Amazon founder Jeff Bezos, also bought in.

LeCun told AFP that, with the funding round complete, AMI would bring aboard 20-30 people "in the very short term".

He and five co-founders plan to "shift into a higher gear" on developing "world models", or AI systems designed to understand the physical world.

Unlike the text-based large language models (LLMs) behind chatbots like ChatGPT and Gemini, such AIs should understand the world "in the way animals and humans do," he added.

"Yann LeCun is turning a new page in artificial intelligence. This is the France of researchers, builders and the bold. Bravo!" President Emmanuel Macron posted on X.

Based in Paris with offices in New York, Singapore and Montreal, AMI was valued at around \$3.5 billion before this funding round.

- 'Paradigm shift' -

LeCun announced his departure from Meta in November, after 12 years with the owner of Facebook, Instagram and WhatsApp.

He now serves as AMI's non-executive chairman, while Alexandre Lebrun is the Paris-based startup's CEO.

Within three to five years, AML plans to produce "fairly universal intelligent systems" that could be used for

almost any task requiring intelligent machines, such as autonomous driving and robotics, LeCun said.

"I am very clearly in the camp that believes we need a paradigm shift" from the AI reliance on LLMs, he told AFP.

LeCun has been a vocal critic of major AI developers' laser focus on LLMs, which was one reason for why he left Meta -- although he insists he still has "a good relationship with Mark Zuckerberg".

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Money Facts

AMI's work will take up where LeCun left off with research at Meta on a new AI architecture dubbed JEPA.

"It's a direct continuation of that project," he said.

Researchers hope world models will allow AI systems to analyse and predict the behaviour of complex systems, such as a jet engine, a power plant or the organs of a human patient.

LeCun, a dual French-American citizen who remains a computer science professor at New York University, said AMI would focus on research and development in its first year.

Discussions with corporate partners could be held within six to 12 months, he added.

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Illustration shows Meta logo, keyboard and robot hands · Reuters

Reuters

24 September 2025 · 1 min read

(Reuters) -Allies of the United States in Europe and Asia will now have access to Meta Platforms' artificial intelligence system Llama, the company said on Tuesday, a day after the U.S. approved its use for government agencies.

Llama is a large language model capable of processing data, including text, video, images and audio.

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The social media giant is now expanding access to a number of U.S. democratic allies in Europe and Asia: France, Germany, Italy, Japan and South Korea, as well as NATO and European Union institutions, it said in a blog post.

Meta will partner with companies such as [Microsoft](#), Amazon's AWS, Oracle and Palantir, among others, to bring Llama-based solutions to the U.S. allies.

Meta releases its Llama models largely free of charge for use by developers, a strategy CEO Mark Zuckerberg previously stated will pay off in the form of innovative products, less dependence on would-be competitors and greater engagement on the company's core social networks.

The U.S. government's purchasing arm, the General Services Administration, will add Llama to its list of approved AI tools for federal agencies, procurement lead Josh Gruenbaum said on Monday.

(Reporting by Juby Babu in Mexico City; Editing by Alan Barona)

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Luke Juricic

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Investing.com -- Meta Platforms Inc (NASDAQ:META) is readying a technological offensive for 2026, developing a suite of next-generation artificial intelligence models designed to challenge the dominance of OpenAI and Google (NASDAQ:GOOGL), The Wall Street Journal reported on Thursday.

According to the Thursday report from WSJ, citing people familiar with the matter, the social media giant is working on a high-stakes image and video-focused AI model code-named "Mango." Concurrently, the company is developing "Avocado," its next major text-based large language model (LLM).

The new roadmap was reportedly detailed during an internal Q&A on Thursday featuring Meta’s Chief AI Officer Alexandr Wang and Chief Product Officer Chris Cox. The models are expected to release in the first half of 2026, signaling a long-term play to move beyond the incremental updates of the current Llama family.

The development of Mango and Avocado represents the first major output from Meta Superintelligence Labs (MSL), a specialized division created after a major restructuring this past summer. To lead the group, CEO Mark Zuckerberg personally orchestrated high-profile recruiting efforts, poaching more than 20 researchers from OpenAI and hiring Wang, the 28-year-old founder of Scale AI, to oversee the effort.

The move underscores Zuckerberg’s willingness to spend aggressively to close the gap with rivals. As part of the transition, Meta reportedly invested over \$14 billion to acquire a near-majority stake in Scale AI, cementing Wang’s role as the primary architect of Meta’s post-Llama strategy.

During the internal session, Wang emphasized that Avocado will focus heavily on advanced coding capabilities, a traditional weak point for previous Meta models compared to competitors.

More ambitiously, Wang noted that Meta is in the early stages of developing "world models." Unlike current LLMs that predict the next word in a sequence, world models aim to understand physical reality by processing vast amounts of visual information.

Meta stock remained relatively flat in after-hours trade following the WSJ report, though shares rose 2.3% during trading hours.

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